Tilman Graff

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Academic Employment

Columbia University — New York City, NY, USA
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics — *2027 –*

Princeton University — Princeton, NJ, USA
Postdoc, Research Program for Development Economics — *2026–2027*

Education

Harvard University — Cambridge, MA, USA
PhD in Economics. Commitee: Emily Breza, Xavier Gabaix, Gabriel Kreindler, Ludwig Straub — *2020 – 2026*

University of Oxford — Oxford, UK
Master of Philosophy in Economics — *2016 – 2018*

Ludwig Maximilians University Munich — Munich, Germany
Bachelor of Science in Economics — *2014 – 2016*

Technical University Munich — Munich, Germany
Bachelor of Science in Management and Technology — *2012 – 2015*

Working Papers

Depreciation and Growth: Evidence from Machine Repair in Uganda, 2026.

Slack and Economic Development (Michael Walker, Nachiket Shah, Edward Miguel, Dennis Egger, and Felix Samy Soliman), 2025. *reject and resubmit, Journal of Political Economy*

Publications

Optimal Public Transportation Networks: Evidence from the World's Largest Bus Rapid Transit System in Jakarta (with Gabriel Kreindler, Arya Gaduh, Rema Hanna, and Ben Olken), 2026. *American Economic Review 116(9)*

Spatial Inefficiencies in Africa's Trade Network, 2024. *Journal of Development Economics 141*

Falling Living Standards During the COVID-19 Crisis: Quantitative Evidence from Nine Developing Countries (with Egger, Miguel, Warren, Shenoy, Collins, Karlan, Parkerson, Mobarak, Fink, Udry, Walker, Haushofer, Larreboure, Athey, Lopez-Pena, Benhachmi, Humphreys, Lowe, Meriggi, Wabwire, Davis, Pape, Voors, Nekesa, Vernot), 2021. *Science Advances 7(6)*

Invited Conferences and Presentations

2026: Oxford, Stockholm IIES, Bocconi, CREi / Pompeu Fabra, UC Berkeley Economics, Columbia Economics, NBER SI Growth, Princeton, Cornell Development Workshop, UC Santa Barbara, Washington University St. Louis, NBER Development Fall Meeting

2025: World Bank, NEUDC (Tufts), Chicago Fed Rookie Conference, Boston Fed

2024: CSAE (Oxford), NBER Summer Institute, EGC (Yale), NEUDC (Northeastern)

2023: Y-Rise (Yale)

2019: NBER Transportation Economics, CSAE (Oxford), Busara Center, World Bank

2018: Oxford, LSE

Work Experience

Busara Center — Nairobi, Kenya
Research Assistant for Prof. Johannes Haushofer (Princeton) — *2018-2020*

Stipends and Awards

Harvard Economics Department: Multiple research grants (totalling $ 40,000) *2023-2025*
STEG: PhD Research Grant (£15,000) joint with F. Samy Soliman *2023*
Harvard GSAS: Certificate of Student Recognition of Teaching *2022*
UniCredit Foundation: US PhD Scholarship *2020 – 2022*
German Academic Exchange Service: Scholarship for Graduate Studies *2017 – 2018*
Europaeum: Jenkins Memorial Fellowship Oxford *2016 – 2017*
German National Academic Foundation: Fellow *2012 – 2018*

Teaching

Harvard graduate 1st year macro: TF for Xavier Gabaix. Evals: 4.96 / 5.00 *Spring 2023*
Harvard graduate 2nd year macro finance: TF for Xavier Gabaix. Evals: 5.00 / 5.00 *Spring 2023*
Harvard graduate 2nd year spatial development: TF for Gabriel Kreindler. Evals: 4.92 / 5.00 *Fall 2022*

Service

Refereeing: American Economic Journal: Insights, American Economic Review, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Quarterly Journal of Economics, World Bank Economic Review